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ATTICA REPORT DENIES COVER-UP OF POLICE CRIMES



New York state troopers brutalize inmates while retaking Attica Prison on "Bloody Monday," September 13, 1971. New York state officials are now attempting to whitewash the numerous acts of sadism committed by guards and state troopers in the aftermath of the powerful Attica Prison rebellion.

(New York, N.Y.) - In a blatant whitewash of massive cover-up efforts by special Attica prosecutor Anthony G. Simonetti to obstruct prosecution of law enforcement officers responsible for the September 13, 1971, Attica massacre, a special New York state probe into the Attica case has found that "there was no intentional cover-up in the conduct of the Attica investigation."

The probe resulted from a complaint made by former special assistant attorney general in the Attica investigation, Malcolm Bell. Bell voiced the conclusions of many Attica inmates that there was a deliberate destruction of evidence of wholesale crimes committed by guards and state troopers during and after the assault on Attica prison.

In the events surrounding the prison rebellion and assault between September 9 and 13, 43 persons were killed at the upstate "correctional" facility. Thirty-nine were killed and 89 wounded by police officers and guards' gunfire in the 15 minutes it took "to retake" the institution. Four others had been killed earlier.

Since the rebellion, 62 inmates have been charged in 42 indictments with 1,289 counts, including stealing keys and possessing an electric cart. Only one indictment was handed up for an alleged crime by a state trooper, for "reckless endangerment." The trooper's case is pending in court.

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